



शिक्षा मंत्रालय
MINISTRY OF
EDUCATION



INSTITUTION'S
INNOVATION
COUNCIL
(Ministry of HRD Initiative)



Ministry of Education's
INNOVATION CELL
(GOVERNMENT OF INDIA)



(Estt.1983)

CODEFORGE'26

ONE-DAY HACKATHON

PARTICIPANT HANDBOOK

CODE TODAY. FORGE TOMORROW.

“

The best way
to predict the future
is to create it.

— Peter Drucker

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PRESENTED BY

DEPARTMENT OF COMPUTER SCIENCE & ENGINEERING
BNCOE PUSAD

THE EVENT

About CodeForge'26

A high-energy, one-day campus hackathon hosted by the Department of Computer Science & Engineering, Babasaheb Naik College of Engineering (BNCOE), Pusad, in collaboration with the Institution's Innovation Council (IIC). Teams get a focused 4-hour build window to turn a problem statement into a working prototype, then pitch it live to a panel of judges.

This short-format hackathon puts the emphasis on speed, teamwork and clarity of thought. Participants receive their problem statements on the day, then race to transform ideas into functional prototypes within the 4-hour window. At the end of the session, teams present their solutions to a panel of judges, who evaluate every project through interactive questioning against criteria such as originality, feasibility, usability and impact. Through its collaboration with the IIC, CodeForge'26 furthers its mission of fostering an entrepreneurial mindset and encouraging students to apply their knowledge in practical, real-world contexts – giving every team a platform to showcase their skills, gain exposure to innovation practices, and experience the thrill of pitching under pressure. Ultimately, CodeForge'26 is more than a competition: it's a celebration of creativity, collaboration and the spirit of innovation.

Hackathon Themes



Healthcare & Well-being

Build solutions that improve health outcomes and everyday well-being.



Education & Campus Innovation

Reimagine how students learn, collaborate, and experience campus life.



Smart Web & Digital Solutions

Create smart, connected digital tools for real-world problems.

Why Participate?



Rapid Innovation Experience

Learn to convert ideas into working prototypes in just 4 hours – mirroring real startup and industry challenges.



Practical Exposure

Apply classroom knowledge to hands-on problem solving and think under pressure.



Judge Interaction

Present to experts, answer their questions, and sharpen your communication and defense skills.



Networking & Growth

Connect with peers, mentors and innovators across colleges in Maharashtra, opening doors to future opportunities.

Open to: Engineering and Polytechnic students, any year, any branch, from any recognized college across Maharashtra. Cross-college teams are welcome.

WHO CAN PARTICIPATE

Eligibility & Registration

CodeForge'26 is open to student teams from any recognized college across Maharashtra.

Quick Eligibility Checklist

- ✓ Currently studying in an Engineering / Polytechnic college in Maharashtra
- ✓ Carrying original college ID card on event day
- ✓ Registered as part of a team of 1–4 members
- ✓ Bringing a laptop / device required for the team's build

Documents to Carry

- ✓ Original college ID card (mandatory for entry & verification)
- ✓ Printed or digital copy of registration confirmation
- ✓ A valid government photo ID as backup (Aadhar / PAN / Driving Licence), recommended

Team Rules

- Teams may have 1 to 4 members.
- Cross-college teams are welcome — members don't need to be from the same institution.
- Team composition cannot be changed after registration closes.

What to Bring

Laptop & charger, mouse, any hardware/components your project needs, college ID card, and a valid photo ID. Campus Wi-Fi and power outlets are available — consider carrying a power bank as backup.

 **Registration:** Opens through the official CodeForge'26 website, currently being finalized. The registration link will be shared across official communication channels as soon as it goes live. Questions in the meantime? Reach out via email below.

EVENT DAY

Full Day Timeline

3rd September 2026 · BNCOE, Pusad · All times are IST

TIME	DURATION	ACTIVITY
09:00 AM	1 hr	Reporting & Registration Desk — ID verification, allotted lab / workstation.
10:00 AM	15 min	Inauguration Ceremony — welcome address by HoD & faculty dignitaries.
10:15 AM	—	Problem Statement Release — official themes & problem statements announced.
10:15 – 11:15 AM	1 hr	Ideation & Brainstorming (No-Device Round) — plan your idea, tech stack, APIs & devices using only pen and paper.
11:15 AM – 2:00 PM	2 hr 45 min	Build Phase – Round 1 — coding & building begins based on your brainstormed plan.
2:00 – 3:00 PM	1 hr	Lunch Break & Freshen Up — snacks & refreshments provided.
3:00 – 4:30 PM	1 hr 30 min	Build Phase – Round 2 — final round of development & polish.
4:30 PM	—	Judging & Live Demos — expert judges evaluate through demos & Q&A.
5:00 PM	—	Winners Declared & Closing Ceremony — prize distribution & closing remarks.

 **Brainstorming Round:** From 10:15–11:15 AM, laptops and devices stay closed. Use only pen & paper to outline your idea, execution plan, required APIs, devices, and tech stack — coding begins only after 11:15 AM.

GOOD TO KNOW

Important Details

A few essential every participant should keep in mind before event day.

What to Bring

Laptop & charger, mouse, any hardware/components your project needs, college ID card, and a valid photo ID.

Food & Refreshments

Snacks and beverages will be provided during the 2:00–3:00 PM break. Participants with specific dietary needs should inform organizers in advance.

Wi-Fi & Power

Campus Wi-Fi and power outlets will be available in the labs. Consider carrying a power bank as a backup.

Team Rules

Teams of 1–4 members; cross-college teams allowed. Team composition cannot be changed after registration closes.

Open Tools Policy

Open access to AI tools and public APIs is allowed — use them to accelerate your build, but the core idea and implementation must be your team's own work.

Code of Conduct

Plagiarized or pre-built projects will be disqualified. Judges' decisions are final. Respectful conduct is expected from all participants at all times.

Judging Criteria

- **Innovation** — originality and creativity of the idea.
- **Practical Execution** — how functional and complete the working prototype is.
- **UI/UX** — usability and design quality of the solution.
- **Presentation Clarity** — how clearly the team communicates their solution during the demo.

Expected Outcomes for Participants

- **Practical Skill Acquisition** — hands-on experience in rapid prototyping, coding under deadlines, and software architecture.
- **Inter-Campus Networking** — connections and collaborative opportunities across engineering colleges in Maharashtra.
- **Incubation & Startups** — promising ideas can be developed further into final-year major projects or campus startup initiatives via the Institution's Innovation Council.

REWARDS

Prizes & Recognition

 ₹10,000 WINNER + MEMENTO	 ₹7,000 1ST RUNNER-UP+MEMENTO	 ₹5,000 2ND RUNNER-UP + MEMENTO
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✦ Every participant receives a **Certificate of Participation**, in addition to cash prizes and mementos for the top three teams, presented at the Closing Ceremony.

What You Walk Away With

Recognition

Cash prizes, certificates and mementos for the top three teams, plus a Certificate of Participation for everyone.

Real Experience

Confidence and skill-building in rapid prototyping, live pitching, and teamwork under pressure.

Full rules, judging criteria and code of conduct are on the [Rules & Guidelines](#) page.

RULES

Rules & Guidelines

Everything your team needs to follow, from registration through to submission.

1. Team Formation

- Teams must register in advance.
- Each team can have 2–4 members.
- Interdisciplinary collaboration is encouraged.

2. Event Duration

- The hackathon will run for 4 hours on September 3rd.
- All prototypes must be completed and submitted within the given time.

3. Problem Statements

- Problem statements will be announced at the start of the event.
- Teams must select one statement and work exclusively on it.

4. Prototype Development

- Solutions must be developed during the hackathon timeframe only.
- Pre-built projects or previously submitted work are not allowed.
- Open-source libraries, frameworks, and AI tools are permitted, provided they are acknowledged.
- Teams should clearly mention where AI tools were used (e.g., code generation, design assistance, idea validation).

5. Judging & Evaluation

Judges will evaluate prototypes based on:

- Innovation & Creativity
- Technical Feasibility
- Usability & Design
- Effective Use of AI Tools (if applicable)
- Presentation & Communication
- Teamwork & Collaboration

6. Code of Conduct

- Respect fellow participants, mentors, and organizers.
- Plagiarism, misconduct, or misrepresentation of work will lead to disqualification.
- Maintain professionalism and integrity throughout the event.

7. Deliverables

- A working prototype (demo or functional model).
- A short presentation/pitch explaining the solution, including how AI tools were leveraged (if used).

8. Certificates & Prizes

- All participants will receive Certificates of Participation.
- Top three teams will be awarded cash prizes and mementos.

LET'S CONNECT

Contact & Organizing Team

Janata Shikshan Prasarak Mandal's Babasaheb Naik College of Engineering, Pusad · 3rd
September 2026 · 09:00 AM Onwards · BNCOE, Pusad

ORGANIZING COMMITTEE

Dept. of Computer Science & Engineering,
BNCOE Pusad

EMAIL

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Student Coordinators

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Student Organizing Committee

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CSE Dept.

Shravani Samarth
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Krishna Anantwar
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CSE Dept.

Arpita Rathod
CSE Dept.

Sarthak Ubale
CSE Dept.

Swaranjali Deshmukh
CSE Dept.

Shivani Dudhane
CSE Dept.

 **Our website is coming soon.** Registration links and further details will be shared across official channels as soon as the site goes live. Follow BNCOE CSE Department channels for updates.

About the Host Institution

Established in 1983 and affiliated with Sant Gadge Baba Amravati University, BNCOE Pusad is guided by 180+ faculty members across a 30-acre campus. Accredited by AICTE, NBA and NAAC, and rated "Grade A" by the Government of Maharashtra — with programs in Computer Science, Mechanical, Civil, Electrical, and Electronics & Telecommunication.